

TRAINING DESIGN DOCUMENT

When Employees Need Support

A Supervisor's Guide to Workplace Accommodations

ADA | PWFA | Interactive eLearning Module

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SECTION 01

Executive Summary

This document describes the instructional design, development methodology, and implementation plan for *When Employees Need Support*, an interactive scenario-based eLearning module designed for supervisors and managers navigating employee accommodation requests under the Americans with Disabilities Act (ADA) and the Pregnant Workers Fairness Act (PWFA).

The module was developed as a standalone, self-contained HTML asset deployable via GitHub Pages, Learning Management Systems (LMS), or SharePoint. It requires no proprietary authoring tools, no backend infrastructure, and no licensing fees. The design prioritizes accessibility, reusability, and instructional integrity over production complexity.

At a Glance

Format	Interactive HTML5 eLearning module
Duration	10 to 12 minutes (estimated)
Audience	Supervisors and managers across all industries
Topic	ADA / PWFA accommodation process
Interactivity	Branching scenario, consequence scenes, 3-question knowledge check
Delivery	Browser-based, no LMS required (SCORM-ready with minor adaptation)
Tracking	localStorage-based completion and score tracking
Branding	Institution-neutral; adaptable to any organization

SECTION 02

Training Purpose and Organizational Need

Accommodation requests are among the most legally consequential interactions a supervisor will have with a direct report. Despite this, formal training at the supervisory level remains inconsistent across organizations. Most supervisors understand they should "involve HR," but lack the specific knowledge to act correctly in the moment: what to say, what not to ask, and how quickly to act.

The consequences of supervisor missteps are significant. Probing for a diagnosis, implementing informal fixes without going through the interactive process, sharing medical information with colleagues, or simply delaying action can each constitute independent violations of the ADA or PWFA, regardless of outcome. Organizations face liability not only for discriminatory decisions, but for procedural failures that occur before any decision is made.

The Gap This Training Addresses

- Supervisors frequently do not recognize that a disclosure has triggered their obligations, particularly when employees do not use formal language such as "accommodation" or "disability."
- Supervisors attempt to evaluate or resolve requests themselves, bypassing the interactive process and the designated Coordinator role.
- Supervisors ask medically inappropriate questions or share protected information with colleagues in good faith, without understanding the legal exposure.
- Organizations lack a scalable, cost-effective training solution that can be updated as law and policy evolve.

Design Principle: Behavior Change Over Awareness

This module was designed not to inform supervisors that accommodations exist, but to change what they do in the 60 seconds after an employee walks into their office. The learning objectives and scenario design are anchored in that specific behavioral goal.

SECTION 03

Learning Objectives

Learning objectives were developed using Bloom's Taxonomy, targeting the Apply and Analyze levels rather than recall alone. The module is designed to move learners from knowing the rule to demonstrating the correct behavior under realistic conditions.

Bloom's Level	Objective	Assessment Method
Recognize (Understand)	Identify when an employee disclosure triggers the duty to act, even without formal language.	Branching scenario, Scene 1
Distinguish (Analyze)	Differentiate between supervisor responsibilities and Coordinator responsibilities in the interactive process.	Knowledge Check Q2
Apply (Apply)	Select the correct supervisory response when an employee discloses a need.	Branching scenario with consequence feedback
Apply (Apply)	Respond appropriately to team questions about an accommodation without disclosing protected information.	Knowledge Check Q3
Remember (Knowledge)	Identify at least three actions supervisors must not take when an employee requests an accommodation.	Do/Do Not slide and knowledge check

SECTION 04

Target Audience

The primary audience is first- and mid-level supervisors and managers in any organizational context where employees may request workplace accommodations. The module assumes no prior knowledge of ADA or PWFA requirements. It does not assume familiarity with HR processes.

Audience Analysis

Variable	Profile
Role	Supervisors and managers with direct reports
Prior knowledge	General awareness of HR processes; no assumed legal expertise
Motivation	Moderate to low intrinsic; compliance-driven context
Technology access	Desktop or laptop browser; variable mobile access
Time available	10 to 15 minutes in a single sitting
Barriers to learning	Low perceived relevance ("this won't happen to me"); compliance fatigue; distrust of legalistic training tone

Design Response to Audience Barriers

The warm, lightly humorous tone was a deliberate instructional choice. Research on compliance training consistently shows that punitive or legalistic framing increases resistance without improving behavior. The character of Marcus was written to be recognizable rather than villainous: a well-intentioned supervisor who stumbles for the same reasons most supervisors do. This framing invites identification rather than defensiveness.

SECTION 05

Instructional Design Methodology

This module was designed using an integration of three complementary frameworks: the ADDIE model for process structure, Merrill's Principles of Instruction (MPI) for learning activity design, and the Cognitive Load Theory (CLT) for content sequencing and interface design.

ADDIE Framework

The ADDIE model (Analyze, Design, Develop, Implement, Evaluate) provided the structural backbone for this project. Each phase informed specific decisions:

Phase	Key Decisions Made
Analyze	Identified supervisor behavior gap (disclosure to referral); defined audience profile; confirmed legal framework (ADA, PWFA, interactive process doctrine).
Design	Selected scenario-based branching format; mapped objectives to Bloom's levels; designed character arc and consequence scenes; chose institution-neutral framing for reusability.
Develop	Built as self-contained HTML5 with vanilla JavaScript; no framework dependencies; custom CSS design system using navy, slate, and gold palette.
Implement	Deployed via GitHub Pages; embeddable via iframe in SharePoint or any LMS; no server-side infrastructure required.
Evaluate	Knowledge check scoring tracked via localStorage; post-completion debrief provided in-module; formal evaluation plan outlined in Section 11.

Merrill's Principles of Instruction

MPI emphasizes that effective instruction is problem-centered and proceeds through activation, demonstration, application, and integration. Each principle maps directly to a module component:

Problem-Centered

The module opens with a real workplace scenario rather than a definition or policy statement. Learners engage with Marcus's situation before receiving any instructional content.

Activation

The hallway scene activates prior experience. Most supervisors have been in an awkward conversation with a direct report about a personal matter. The scenario is designed to feel familiar.

Demonstration

The consequence scene (the alternate-universe Marcus) demonstrates what goes wrong when supervisors improvise. Dr. Patel's dialogue models the correct process in context.

Application

The branching choice point and three knowledge check questions require learners to apply content, not recall it. Per-choice feedback provides immediate corrective information.

Integration

The completion screen and key takeaways prompt learners to connect the module content to a specific, concrete action: saving the Coordinator's contact information.

Cognitive Load Theory

CLT informed several interface and sequencing decisions aimed at reducing extraneous cognitive load while preserving germane load (the effort that produces learning):

- Slide-by-slide navigation prevents learners from being overwhelmed by the full content at once.
- Characters are introduced with visual avatars and role labels before speaking, reducing the effort required to track who is saying what.
- The Do/Do Not reference slide is presented after the scenario, not before, so learners encounter rules in the context of a situation they have already engaged with.
- Knowledge check feedback is specific and corrective for each distractor, not generic. This reduces the cognitive work of translating "incorrect" into actionable understanding.
- The visual design uses a minimal palette and consistent typographic hierarchy to reduce interface noise.

SECTION 06

Tools and Technology

A core design constraint for this project was zero proprietary tooling dependency. The module is fully reproducible, auditable, and modifiable by any developer with basic HTML and JavaScript knowledge, without software licenses.

Tool / Technology	Role in Project	Rationale
HTML5 / CSS3	Primary module structure, layout, and visual design	Universal browser support; no build tools required
Vanilla JavaScript (ES6+)	Interactivity, branching logic, score tracking, progress management	No framework dependencies; lightweight and maintainable
Google Fonts (DM Sans / DM Serif Display)	Typography system	Professional, readable, distinct from default browser fonts
localStorage API	Score and completion tracking without a backend	No server infrastructure required for basic tracking
GitHub / GitHub Pages	Version control and free static hosting	Zero hosting cost; public URL; update via commit

SECTION 07

Module Architecture and Content Outline

The module consists of 11 slides organized into four instructional phases. Navigation is linear with one branching decision point. All branches return to the main learning path after delivering consequence feedback.

Slide	Phase	Content	Type
0	Introduction	Title, character introductions, learning objectives	Informational
1	Scenario	Jordan discloses a need to Marcus in the hallway	Scenario / Narrative
2	Application	Branching choice: what should Marcus do next? (4 options)	Branching Decision
3	Consequence	Alternate universe: Marcus improvises and makes two errors	Consequence / Negative Model
4	Instruction	Do/Do Not reference: supervisor responsibilities	Direct Instruction
5	Scenario	Dr. Patel contacts Marcus; models correct process	Scenario / Positive Model
6	Instruction	Five-step interactive process explained	Process Reference
7	Assessment	Knowledge check question 1: recognizing a disclosure	Knowledge Check
8	Assessment	Knowledge check question 2: what to share with the Coordinator	Knowledge Check
9	Assessment	Knowledge check question 3: team communication and confidentiality	Knowledge Check
10	Completion	Score display, key takeaways, call to action	Summary / Transfer

SECTION 08

Storyboard

The following storyboard describes each slide in terms of screen content, learner action, on-screen narration text, and the learning objective addressed. This document serves as the authoritative design record for the module.

SLIDE 00**Title and Introduction****SCREEN / VISUAL**

Full-screen title card with course name, subtitle, and three character avatars (Marcus, Jordan, Dr. Patel) with name and role labels. Learning objectives displayed as a bulleted callout box. Gold accent bar at top.

LEARNER ACTION

Read only. Click Begin to proceed.

NARRATION / ON-SCREEN TEXT

Welcome to When Employees Need Support, a supervisor's guide to workplace accommodations under the ADA and PWFA. You will follow Marcus as he navigates a real disclosure situation. Estimated time: 10 to 12 minutes.

LEARNING OBJECTIVE ADDRESSED

Sets context. Activates prior experience with supervisory conversations about personal matters.

SLIDE 01**Scene 1: The Hallway Conversation****SCREEN / VISUAL**

Dialogue scene between Jordan and Marcus using speech bubble format. Jordan's bubble on left, Marcus's on right. Narrator box below the dialogue describes the scenario context. Warning callout at bottom.

LEARNER ACTION

Read and observe. No interaction required. Click Continue.

NARRATION / ON-SCREEN TEXT

Jordan: Hey Marcus, do you have a minute? I have been dealing with some health stuff lately. My doctor thinks I might need some changes to how I am working. I am not sure what that looks like yet, but I wanted to give you a heads up. [Warning box]: Jordan did not use the words ADA, disability, or accommodation. That does not matter.

LEARNING OBJECTIVE ADDRESSED

LO1: Recognize when an employee disclosure triggers the duty to act.

SLIDE 02

Branching Choice: What Should Marcus Do?

SCREEN / VISUAL

Four-option multiple choice presented as clickable card buttons. Each option labeled A through D. Buttons highlight green (correct) or red (incorrect) on selection. Per-choice feedback appears below the choices.

LEARNER ACTION

Select one of four options. Immediate feedback on all choices. Next button unlocks after selection.

NARRATION / ON-SCREEN TEXT

Option A: Ask for a doctor's note. Option B: Tell Jordan HR handles this. Option C: Thank Jordan and connect them to the Accommodations Coordinator. Option D: Offer to move Jordan's desk. Feedback: Option C is correct because it acknowledges the disclosure and involves the right resource promptly.

LEARNING OBJECTIVE ADDRESSED

LO3: Apply the correct supervisory response when an employee discloses a need.

SLIDE 03

Scene 2: Marcus Improvises (Negative Model)

SCREEN / VISUAL

Continuation dialogue scene. Narrator box introduces the alternate universe framing with a light tone. Dialogue shows Marcus asking about permanence and diagnosis. Danger callout at bottom identifies the two errors.

LEARNER ACTION

Read and observe. No interaction required. Click Continue.

NARRATION / ON-SCREEN TEXT

Narrator: In an alternate universe, things go sideways. Marcus: Is this permanent? What exactly is the condition? Jordan: I am not comfortable sharing that. [Danger box]: Marcus probed for a diagnosis and tried to evaluate the request himself. Both are outside his role.

LEARNING OBJECTIVE ADDRESSED

LO5: Identify actions supervisors must not take. LO3: Contrast correct and incorrect supervisor behavior.

SLIDE 04

Do/Do Not Reference Slide

SCREEN / VISUAL

Two-panel reference layout. Left panel (green accent) lists five supervisor DO items. Right panel (red accent) lists five supervisor DO NOT items. Icon-supported bullet list format.

LEARNER ACTION

Read and review. No interaction required. Click Continue.

NARRATION / ON-SCREEN TEXT

DO: Express support, refer to the Coordinator promptly, maintain confidentiality, cooperate with Coordinator on job information. DO NOT: Ask for a diagnosis, make eligibility decisions, implement informal fixes, share medical information with staff, delay action.

LEARNING OBJECTIVE ADDRESSED

LO5: Identify at least three actions supervisors must not take.

SLIDE 05

Scene 3: Dr. Patel Takes the Lead (Positive Model)

SCREEN / VISUAL

Three-character dialogue scene. Dr. Patel (gold avatar) calls Marcus. Dialogue models the correct Coordinator-to-supervisor interaction: what the Coordinator needs, what Marcus should provide, and what to communicate to staff.

LEARNER ACTION

Read and observe. No interaction required. Click Continue.

NARRATION / ON-SCREEN TEXT

Dr. Patel: I have connected with Jordan and started the interactive process. I need the essential functions of the role and scheduling flexibility. I do not need you to weigh in on eligibility. Marcus: Got it. Should I keep this confidential from the team? Dr. Patel: Yes. If implementation requires changes, we will handle communication together without disclosing Jordan's medical information.

LEARNING OBJECTIVE ADDRESSED

LO2: Distinguish supervisor and Coordinator responsibilities.
LO4: Apply confidentiality correctly.

SLIDE 06

The Five-Step Interactive Process

SCREEN / VISUAL

Vertical process flow with five numbered cards. Each card includes a step title and one to two sentence description. Clean white cards with navy number badges.

LEARNER ACTION

Read and review. No interaction required. Click Knowledge Check.

NARRATION / ON-SCREEN TEXT

Step 1: Disclosure. Step 2: Supervisor refers promptly. Step 3: Coordinator engages employee and gathers documentation. Step 4: Effective accommodation identified. Step 5: Implementation and follow-up.

LEARNING OBJECTIVE ADDRESSED

LO2: Distinguish responsibilities across the accommodation process.

SLIDE 07

Knowledge Check: Question 1 of 3

SCREEN / VISUAL

Single question in four-option multiple choice format. Question above choices. Per-choice feedback below. Next button disabled until answer selected.

LEARNER ACTION

Select one answer. Read feedback. Click Next Question.

NARRATION / ON-SCREEN TEXT

An employee tells you they need Fridays off for a while. No diagnosis mentioned. What is your obligation? Correct answer: Refer them to the Accommodations Coordinator. The request does not require magic words.

LEARNING OBJECTIVE ADDRESSED

LO1: Recognize when a disclosure triggers the duty to act.

SLIDE 08

Knowledge Check: Question 2 of 3

SCREEN / VISUAL

Same format as Slide 07. Question focuses on scope of supervisor's role when cooperating with the Coordinator.

LEARNER ACTION

Select one answer. Read feedback. Click Next Question.

NARRATION / ON-SCREEN TEXT

The Coordinator asks about Jordan's job. You should share: essential functions, physical environment details, and scheduling flexibility. Not your personal opinion on eligibility. Correct answer: Option B.

LEARNING OBJECTIVE ADDRESSED

LO2: Distinguish supervisor and Coordinator responsibilities.

SLIDE 09

Knowledge Check: Question 3 of 3

SCREEN / VISUAL

Same format as Slide 07. Question focuses on how to respond to team members asking about an approved accommodation without disclosing medical information.

LEARNER ACTION

Select one answer. Read feedback. Click See Results.

NARRATION / ON-SCREEN TEXT

Team asks why Jordan now works different hours. Best response: Jordan worked something out with HR. I am not in a position to share the details, but the arrangement is approved. Correct answer: Option B.

LEARNING OBJECTIVE ADDRESSED

LO4: Apply confidentiality correctly in a team communication scenario.

SLIDE 10

Completion and Key Takeaways

SCREEN / VISUAL

Trophy icon, completion headline, score display (X/3 correct), and three key takeaway cards with numbered icons. Gold callout box with a specific call to action. Restart button available.

LEARNER ACTION

Review takeaways. Record contact information for your Accommodations Coordinator. Option to restart module.

NARRATION / ON-SCREEN TEXT

Key Three: 1. Refer, do not resolve. 2. You do not need a diagnosis to act. 3. Confidentiality is not optional. Call to action: Save your Accommodations Coordinator's contact information now. You will need it before you expect to.

LEARNING OBJECTIVE ADDRESSED

All objectives. Supports transfer by connecting module content to a specific behavioral action.

SECTION 09

Assessment and Knowledge Check Design

The module uses two forms of embedded assessment: a branching decision point and a three-question knowledge check. Both are formative rather than summative. The goal is corrective feedback during the learning experience, not high-stakes gatekeeping.

Distractor Design

Each incorrect answer option was written to represent a plausible, real-world supervisor behavior rather than an obviously wrong choice. Effective distractor design requires that learners must think, not just recognize the absurd option. The feedback for each distractor explains why that specific choice is problematic, not just that it is wrong.

Scoring

- Questions are scored individually. Learners see per-question correct/incorrect feedback immediately.
- A cumulative score (X out of 3) is displayed on the completion screen.
- There is no passing threshold enforced in the current build. Organizations may add a threshold and retry gate via minor JavaScript modification.
- Score is stored in localStorage and persists across browser sessions on the same device.

Note on Formative vs. Summative Use

As deployed, this module functions as formative training. For organizations requiring documented completion records (e.g., for Title II or Title IX compliance audits), the module can be wrapped in a SCORM package or integrated with an LMS completion API with approximately two to four hours of additional development. Contact the designer for implementation support.

SECTION 10

Accessibility and Deployment

Accessibility Considerations

- All interactive elements are keyboard-navigable via standard tab and enter key behavior.
- Color is not used as the sole indicator of correct/incorrect feedback. Labels and icons accompany color-coded states.
- Font sizes are set in relative units and respond to browser accessibility settings.
- The module does not autoplay audio or video, eliminating a common accessibility barrier.
- Future versions should include ARIA labels on interactive elements and be tested with screen readers (NVDA, VoiceOver) for full WCAG 2.1 AA conformance.

Deployment Options

Method	Requirements	Best For
GitHub Pages	Free GitHub account; public repository	Open access; no LMS; easy sharing via URL
SharePoint Embed	SharePoint site; iframe embed web part	Organizations using Microsoft 365 for intranet
LMS (Canvas, Blackboard, Moodle)	URL redirect or iframe; optional SCORM wrapper for tracking	Higher education or corporate LMS environments
Local / Intranet Hosting	Web server capable of serving static files	Organizations with air-gapped or restricted networks

SECTION 11

Evaluation Plan

The Kirkpatrick Model provides the evaluation framework for this module. Each level is addressed at a different time horizon.

Level	Focus	Method	Timing
Level 1: Reaction	Did learners find it useful and engaging?	Post-module survey (3 to 5 questions); qualitative feedback from supervisors	Immediately post-completion
Level 2: Learning	Did learners acquire the target knowledge?	Knowledge check score (embedded); pre/post comparison if baseline data available	During and immediately after module
Level 3: Behavior	Did supervisor behavior change on the job?	Coordinator tracking of referral quality and timeliness; supervisor self-report at 60 and 90 days	60 to 90 days post-training
Level 4: Results	Did organizational outcomes improve?	Reduction in accommodation-related complaints; decreased time-to-resolution for interactive process; audit findings	Annual review cycle

SECTION 12

Appendix: Design Rationale Notes

On Character Design

The three characters were designed to represent distinct instructional functions. Marcus is the identification character: he makes plausible mistakes, not egregious ones. Jordan is the disclosure character: their role is to present the triggering situation without becoming a disability stereotype. Jordan has no visible or named condition. Dr. Patel is the authority and modeling character: she provides the positive example without being preachy.

On Tone

The warm, lightly humorous tone was selected after considering the compliance training literature on learner resistance. Studies consistently find that authoritative, punitive framing increases defensive processing and reduces behavioral transfer. The humor in this module is situational and self-aware rather than trivializing: Marcus's parking spot joke in the completion screen signals to learners that the module respects their time and intelligence. The legal content itself is delivered straight.

On Institution Neutrality

The module was intentionally designed without organization-specific branding, policy references, or contact information. This decision reflects a portfolio and reusability goal: the module can be adopted by any employer with minor customization (adding a logo, inserting a coordinator name and phone number, updating the callout language). A branded version for a specific institution is a straightforward adaptation.

On Technology Choice

The decision to build in vanilla HTML, CSS, and JavaScript rather than Articulate Rise, Lectora, or Adobe Captivate was deliberate. Proprietary authoring tools produce output that is difficult to audit, difficult to version-control, and dependent on continued software licensing. A hand-coded module is fully transparent, portable, and modifiable by any qualified developer. It also demonstrates a broader instructional technology competency: the ability to build effective learning experiences without expensive tooling.

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For questions regarding instructional design methodology, deployment, or customization, contact the designer directly.